

“INDIAN UNITY CANNOT AND SHOULD NOT BE AT THE EXPENSE OF ITS DIVERSITY.”

Breaking with tradition

Elamkulam Manakkal Sankaran Namboodiripad, commonly known as ‘EMS’, was born in the present-day state of Kerala. Although initially tutored in Sanskrit and religious scriptures at home, EMS broke with tradition to pursue a formal, modern education. He also fought against the traditional caste and gender-based discrimination practised within the Namboodiri community, which was one of the most orthodox and privileged in the state. A member of the Congress party in his youth, he participated in the civil disobedience movement, for which he was sent to prison.